

fax machine and if you operate from your home then there are plenty of affordable internet fax services.

## Controversy

There has been a bit of a concern over two things with printers. Manufacturers have installed microchips on the cartridges that self-destruct once you near the end of the cartridge capacity. This makes it impossible to refill a cartridge and forces the customer to spend a lot of money on buying an official cartridge.

Companies even have print counters installed in new printers so that once in its lifetime if the total amount of printouts exceed a certain threshold level the printer becomes useless. This counter then has to be reset manually. Enterprising people on the internet have come up with software and tutorials that allows customers to reset these counters for a few bucks.

## What to buy

When looking to buy an all-in-one printer / scanner / copier keep the following points in mind.

- 1 The speed at which a printer can function should allow you to estimate whether a printer will be able to handle your workload without being a bottleneck in the entire work process.
- 2 Inkjet printers are cheap and easy to refill, so they are economical in the long run.
- 3 If your network router has a USB port then you can connect your printer to the router directly and thus avoid having to turn on the PC which might otherwise be connected to the printer.
- 4 The more complex a printer and more features it has, the more likely it has to undergo maintenance. So when buying a printer for someone that is not technically inclined, stick to a simple printer.
- 5 While the manufacturer may claim a certain cartridge will output 1000's of pages they don't mention that in their test conditions they only require each page to have approximately 15-20% ink coverage. So printing a full quality image that covers an entire page will consume about 5-10% of your cartridge's ink capacity. 